

Tutorial 'ITH Plush Keychain'

You wanna create an „in the hoop“ keychain/charm but never made any? No problem. The following instructions helps you with the very beginning :)

How to ITH keychains?

The base is a working embroidery machine and a matching ith file. Each machine manufacturer has its own file type to its machines. Pay attention to get your file in the correct type. With every embroidery machine a hoop in the right size is essential. Every lillipaya ith keychain pattern works with a minimum hoop size of 4x4 inches. Bigger hoops are possible, smaller doesn't work

What supplies do I need?



- cut away stabilizer
- water soluble stabilizer
- minky (or other fabric)
- embroidery threads
- sewing thread + needle
- grosgrain (Ribbon,[..])
- scissors
- embroidery scissors
- (batting)
- (keyring)

The example pattern needs:

Minky in two colors (lilac and light pink)

Embroidery threads in light orange for beak and feet, black for the eyes, pink for blush and heart applique and matching lilac similar to fabric color plus hand sewing thread in similar color



It's important that the „**decoration**“ seams have a as similar as possible color to the fabric. Kinda darker like in the example is fine, but the better the color matches the fabric the better is the final look of the keychain.

Let's go!

Cut away stabilizer and minky in main color stretch into the hoop (stabilizer at bottom, fabric on top). Check your supplied sewing order and get your materials ready to use. If your ith pattern includes applique (a second, sewed on fabric) will this always be the first step on lillipaya embroidery patterns.

The applique

First step is to embroider the „**position**“ of your applique. Now you have to hang up the fabric in your needed applique color in this area. Afterwards you fix the fabric with the „**border**“.



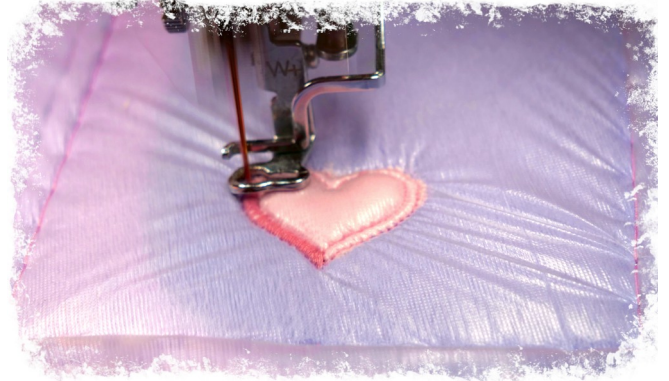
As soon as your applique fabric is fixed, you have to cut away the produding fabric (as near as possible to your seam). There are special applique scissors availble. But a sharp embroidery or nail scissors can do a good job too.



Because minky is a fabric with short pile, you have to hang up and machine pin water soluble stabilizer now. Without this stabilizer you'd see random piles within your embroidery and get a messy look. If you use fabric without pile you don't need any added stabilizer on the top.

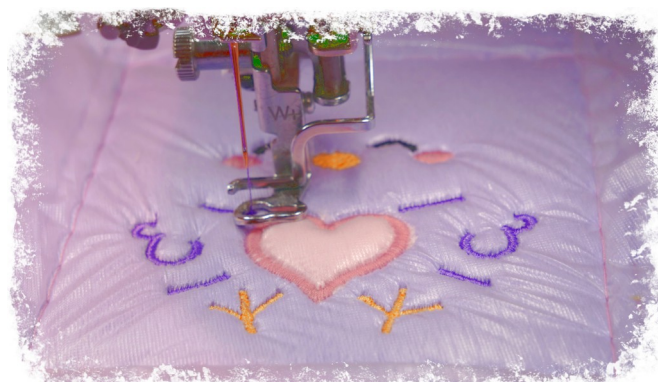
The design

Hang up the water soluble stabilizer generously and let the machine pin it. Afterwards go on with the thread colors of the sewing order and embroider and change colors are described.



In most cases a „**decoration border**“ is added to your cutted applique edge.

[If you have jump stitches (threads between embroidery parts – older embroidery machines do this) cut them after each stitched out color]



The keychain grosgrain

Remove the water soluble stabilizer carefully before you add the grosgrain. Best choice is grosgrain in 2 inches length. Fold it in the middle and hang up on the embroidered „**position**“. The folded part of the grosgrain looking at the middle of the embroidery.



If you wanna use the keychain as decoration instead of a keychain/charm is ribbon or something similar a good choice too.

The backside

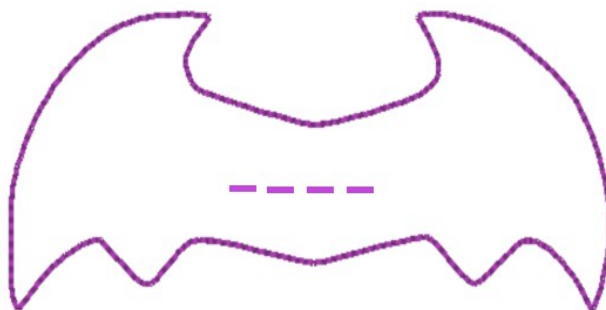
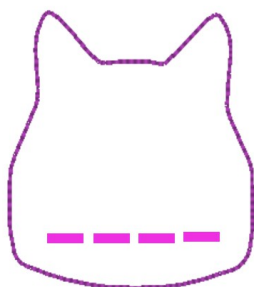
Hang up the backside fabric right side to right side (fluffy fabric side on embroidered side) on the hoop and embroider the „**keychain border**“ to fix it.



Lillipaya ith keychain patterns have an opening to upend included in the design.

But if a design includes some more pieces, those may have no opening. Such need to be cut carefully with scissors on the backside to open it. Those pieces may be something like heads, wings or additional details to sew on the main part.

Cut the opening line around 0.7 inches. Some examples:



Nearly done!

The embroidery is done so take the fabric out of the hoop. There might be a note in your sewing order, if you need a second hoop for your chosen design.

Remove stabilizer, cut and upend

The bottom stabilizer must be removed now and the charm cut out with about 0.4 mm edge next to the seam. Cut the grosgrain more generously so that it cannot break on stronger use. At tips and corners, the fabric must be shortened and cut. This keeps sure that you're able to shape the embroidered shapes well as soon as it's upend.



Without incisions, the charm will not correspond to the intended look. Corners and tips are trimmed as marked in pink. Pinch the seam addition at corners to just before the seam and cut off tips until shortly before the seam. After cutting upend the charm. For this purpose, various auxiliary items can prove to be practical. A large rounded tweezers, a forceps clamp or a chopstick can do a good job here.

In the case of the bird, it is advisable to press the tip on the head or a wing inwards and then push it through the turning opening with the appropriate auxiliary tool. For the rest, simply hold on to the already inverted piece and pull the body backwards. If you have a clamp, as shown in the picture, the fabric can be grasped directly through the opening and pulled through)

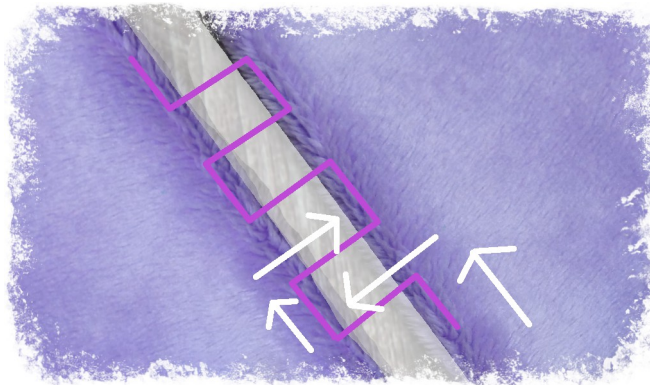


If the charm is completely turned over, the individual parts (curves, tips, body parts) are formed through the reversible opening with a tool of your choice. (For this step, snapping in the corners was important).

Flat or fluffy

Fill (or not) the keychain and close the opening..

For plush keychains small silicone fiberfill fits better than regular batting. It's both fine, but with those small fiberfill balls you can fill and form easier small details..



Close the hole with the „leather stitch“ like in the upper picture.

Remove small leftover pieces of water soluble stabilizer and brush and clean your plush keychain now (from fabric and thread leftovers). Keyring on it and finished!

Enjoy your plush keychain!



Any questions? Leave a mail at
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I'd love to see your work. Feel free to
share it with me on instagram! :)

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